

World Wide Web

So much of what we do in our daily lives relies on the World Wide Web—an easy-to-use system that has made the Internet available to all. For many of us, social media is our preferred way of communicating. We use the Internet to shop, pay bills, watch TV, and play games. In some countries, people even vote in elections online.

MAKING CONNECTIONS

British computer scientist Tim Berners-Lee was working at CERN, the European particle physics laboratory near Geneva, Switzerland, when he developed the “World Wide Web” in 1989. He imagined an open platform of connected computers that would allow people around the world to share information and collaborate.

Berners-Lee's own computer was the Web's first server—to ensure the Web was not switched off, a label read, “This machine is a server. DO NOT POWER DOWN!!!”

FAST FACTS

- 70 percent of all emails sent are spam.
- In 2010, Finland made access to the Internet a legal right for everyone.
- China has a treatment center for Internet addicts in Beijing.
- The most well-connected cities are currently in South Korea and Japan. They have average bandwidth speeds almost three times as fast as in the US.

▼ TIM BERNERS-LEE

The inventor of the Internet stands by the NeXT computer on which he developed the World Wide Web.

